

BALAAJEE VR

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Chennai, India

Immediate Availability • EU Blue Card Eligible

LinkedIn Profile

PORTFOLIO

Leadership Deck

Design Gallery

CORE SKILLS

STRATEGIC DESIGN

- UX Vision & Strategy
- Product Roadmapping
- Feasibility Negotiation
- Lean UX
- Cross-Functional Workshops

TEAM OPERATIONS

- Resource Planning
- Mentorship & Coaching
- Hiring & Team Building
- Agile / PI Planning
- Design System Governance

TECHNICAL COLLABORATION

- Engineering Handoffs
- Scope Management
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Delivery & Performance Management

EDUCATION

B.E. Information Technology

TECHNOLOGY & AI STACK

AI & Automation: Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, IBM Watson, Google Stitch, NotebookLM, Google AI Studio, Gemini for Workspace

Design & Strategy: Figma, Miro, Mural

Product Operations: Jira, Monday.com, Confluence

Research & Analytics: UserTesting, Hotjar, Google Analytics

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Samsung: 10-Year US Business Visa for driving global healthcare UX research.

Ericsson: Spot Award for sustaining UX innovation culture.

Ericsson: 1st Place, Global Hack-fest Optimization Contest.

Product Impact: Designed "Greedy Jump" iOS app (80K+ downloads).

Design Contests: 1st Place in MockingBOT & UP Labs UX Challenges.

UX DESIGN EXECUTIVE

18 + Years

Building world-class design organizations

12+	10M+	8+
TEAM SCALE	USERS IMPACTED	INDUSTRIES

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Capitalizing on 18+ years of leadership across B2C, B2B, and B2E sectors—spanning Finance, Telecom, Healthcare, Gaming, Entertainment, and Enterprise Technology—to solve complex business problems. Proven track record of bridging the gap between design vision and engineering feasibility to protect delivery timelines. Strategic leader skilled in stakeholder negotiation, process optimization, and aligning user-centered design with core business outcomes across global markets.

WORK EXPERIENCE

UI/UX Design Senior Manager
Sep 2024 — Jan 2026

IBM India Software Labs

- Orchestrated a UX team re-org, transitioning 14 designers from product-specific silos to a centralized UX-as-a-Service model to optimize resource allocation and foster cross-functional collaboration across global enterprise products.
- Integrated AI tools into day-to-day design operations, mentoring and upskilling the team to accelerate workflows and align technical execution with high-level UX vision.
- Standardized UX governance for AI transformation by conducting cross-functional workshops across the product portfolio, ensuring IBM Watson capabilities were seamlessly embedded to mitigate deployment risks in mission-critical environments.
- Spearheaded the strategic integration of IBM Watson into Rhapsody SE, architecting AI-UX frameworks that simplified enterprise-scale modeling workflows and significantly reduced cognitive load for global engineering teams.
- Directed the UX transformation of MaaS360 by leveraging IBM Watson to automate complex endpoint management protocols, delivering a proactive, multi-tenant experience for global enterprise IT administrators.

UI/UX Product Design Manager
Jul 2021 — Aug 2024

Zebra Technologies

- Directed a multi-disciplinary UI/UX team across complex B2B hardware and software portfolios, acting as the primary Hiring Manager to scale a high-performing design organization and optimize global resource allocation.
- Negotiated product roadmaps directly with global enterprise accounts and sales leadership, translating complex market needs and deep user insights into strategic design initiatives that drove measurable business outcomes.
- Championed Lean UX methodologies and led organizational Agile/PI planning sessions, facilitating cross-functional workshops to proactively resolve technical constraints and align design vision with engineering execution.
- Standardized design system governance across multiple product squads, establishing scalable UI frameworks that accelerated engineering handoffs and ensured visual consistency across enterprise applications.
- Established a proactive, user-centered product vision by synthesizing competitive analysis and generative research into actionable UX strategies, shifting the team from reactive delivery to strategic innovation.

UI/UX Senior Specialist
Oct 2020 — Jul 2021

ZF Wabco

- Spearheaded the UX strategy for mission-critical vehicle infotainment and fleet tracking software, translating complex automotive requirements into intuitive, driver-centric interfaces.
- Scaled the enterprise Design System, establishing robust UI standards that ensured visual consistency and accelerated engineering handoffs across multiple global product squads.
- Led cross-functional collaboration between product management and engineering, utilizing advanced user research (heatmaps, usability testing) to drive data-informed design decisions.

UI/UX Designer
Jul 2019 — Sep 2020

Ericsson Global

- Partnered with internal stakeholders and global teams to align business requirements with user needs, facilitating cross-functional UX workshops to define product strategy.
- Architected and maintained the Ericsson Design System, standardizing UI components to streamline development cycles and enforce brand consistency.
- Executed comprehensive market analysis and generative user research, translating complex technical constraints into actionable information architecture and seamless user journeys.

Lead UI/UX Designer
Sep 2017 — Jul 2019

NP Compete Technologies

- Directed end-to-end product design cycles, managing sprint planning, resource allocation, and a team of designers to ensure timely delivery of high-fidelity prototypes.
- Led customer requirement gathering sessions, acting as the primary UX liaison to translate complex business needs into strategic, actionable design roadmaps.
- Facilitated stakeholder UX workshops and conducted rigorous market research to establish foundational style guides, UI patterns, and robust information architecture.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Freelance UI/UX Designer** — May 2015 — Aug 2017
- **Creative Head** — Titi Technologies — May 2010 — Apr 2015
- **Senior Software Engineer** — Infosys Technologies — Jan 2006 — Apr 2010